



September 22, 2025

Hon. Michelle L. Phillips
Secretary
New York Public Service Commission
3 Empire State Plaza
Albany, NY 12223-1350

RE: Case 18-E-0138: Proceeding on Motion of the Commission to Regarding Electric Vehicle Supply Equipment and Infrastructure.

**Comments of the Vehicle-Grid Integration Council (VGIC)
on Petition Requesting Eligibility Changes to the Medium- and Heavy-Duty Pilot**

Introduction

The Vehicle-Grid Integration Council (VGIC) is a 501(c)(6) membership-based trade association committed to advancing the role of electric vehicles (EVs) and vehicle-grid integration (VGI) through policy development, education, outreach, and research. VGIC supports the transition to decarbonized transportation and electric sectors by ensuring the value from flexible EV charging and discharging is recognized and compensated to achieve a more reliable, affordable, and efficient electric grid. VGIC appreciates the opportunity to comment on the Petition Requesting Eligibility Changes to the Medium- and Heavy-Duty Pilot, filed May 23, 2025.

VGIC supports the Joint Utilities' petition to expand eligibility for MHDV incentives.

Given the considerable size of the remaining budget allocated to support MHDV customers and anticipated increase in MHDV deployments in coming years to meet customer

demand, **VGIC strongly supports the Joint Utilities’ petition to expand eligibility for MHDV incentives to shared hub models, projects outside of disadvantaged communities, and projects without a TVIP, NYSBIP, NYCCTP, EPA CSB, or EPA CHDV voucher.**

VGIC recommends that sites with bidirectional charging equipment have a higher share of eligible customer side costs.

Bidirectional charging use cases can leverage the latent battery capacity in EVs to provide backup power to customers, manage customer bills, and support the grid through vehicle-to-grid (“V2G”) exports. Revenues from V2G exports can be even more important for certain MHDV EVs compared to light-duty EVs, helping to offset the significant costs of vehicles and associated charging infrastructure and making electrification projects more financially viable. Ultimately, the extent to which V2G exports will support MHDV project economics will be determined by vehicle routes, duty cycles, and customer preferences. Bidirectional vehicles and EVSE are commercially available for the MHDV sector, with current charging station offerings from Nuvve/Fermata, Heliox, InCharge, and Tellus Power Green and vehicles from GM, Blue Bird, RIDE, Thomas Built Buses / Daimler, Green Power Motors, and other MHDV providers. Several V2G projects currently participate in and receive compensation from California’s Emergency Load Reduction Program and Massachusetts’ ConnectedSolutions Daily Dispatch program. Moreover, the Joint Utilities maintain VDER tariffs for which V2G customers are eligible.

Given the immense potential of V2G systems to support customer needs, bolster grid reliability, and lower system costs, **VGIC recommends offering an incrementally higher share of eligible costs to these customers compared to sites with only unidirectional charging equipment.** This will help to partially offset the incremental upfront costs of purchasing and installing bidirectional EVSE and the associated equipment, which are a significant barrier given the relatively nascent state of the market, which has not yet benefited from economies of scale in production and distribution. Based on VGIC’s discussion with industry participants, there is an approximately 30% cost premium for a bidirectional EVSE for

MHDV sites compared to a unidirectional EVSE. VGIC believes offering to cover an incrementally higher share of eligible costs is critical to spurring the nascent bidirectional charging market in New York. VGIC offers itself as a resource and hopes to collaborate closely with stakeholders to determine the appropriate incentive level for bidirectional charging equipment. **However, covering 80% of customer-side costs for bidirectional sites, as opposed to the 50% for unidirectional sites, may help to offset the current ~30% premium that these sites face. Ultimately, the goal of such market transition support for bidirectional charging customers is to reduce ratepayer costs by mitigating distribution system upgrades.** This would help to offset VGIC's proposed incrementally higher incentive for bidirectional sites. VGIC recognizes the critical need to balance forward-looking initiatives and investments in a diverse long-term energy toolkit with maintaining affordability for all utility ratepayers. With this in mind, we believe that if the Commission does adopt an incrementally higher incentive for bidirectional charging sites, it could also consider additional ratepayer protection measures. For example, the Commission could request an attestation that the site will, in fact, be used in bidirectional mode.

In addition, while V2X solutions have demonstrated clear benefits to both customers and the grid across the country, the technology is new and unfamiliar to many customers. To overcome this gap, VGIC recommends that the MHDV pilot marketing, education, and outreach and technical assistance teams work to educate customers on the benefits of bidirectional charging use cases, capable chargers, vehicles, and associated equipment, appropriate interconnection pathways, applicable rates and programs, and any technical considerations, including opportunities to co-locate and integrate other types of distributed energy resources. Given the potential complexity of interconnecting relatively large bidirectional MHDV sites, the utilities' technical assistance teams should – in a technology-neutral manner – actively support individual customers and fleets through the design and interconnection process and ensure a streamlined customer experience.

VGIC recommends that applicants be provided with education about flexible service connection options.

Flexible service connection refers to the use of behind-the-meter software (e.g., power sharing algorithms, power control systems, etc.) or hardware (e.g., integrated or co-located battery storage, linear generators, etc.) approaches to limit EV charging demand at the service connection to a predetermined level below the aggregated charging capacity of the EVSE. For example, a charging site with five 150 kW DCFCs can use these technologies to limit its peak demand to 600 kW, compared to a nameplate aggregate peak demand of 750 kW. This can help avoid or defer the need to upgrade certain customer-side and utility-side make-ready infrastructure to accommodate the new charging load. The reduced need for infrastructure upgrades can generate savings for the customer installing EV charging and, critically, **all ratepayers**. The potential savings from these flexible service connections can be considerable given the significant infrastructure needs of MHDVs. **These solutions are also particularly valuable given New York’s commitment to proactive planning frameworks – flexible service connection provides a complimentary tool to accelerate EV energization while also providing the potential to mitigate upward pressure on rates.** Additionally, flexible service connection can be used to overcome physical space constraints in locations where it is difficult to upgrade electrical equipment. This can also rapidly accelerate installation and energization timelines.

The enabling technologies for flexible service connection are mature and already being deployed today, and therefore should be considered in all near-term activities related to MHDV electrification. **Specifically, VGIC urges the Commission to direct utilities to ensure education about these flexible service connection options be provided to prospective and accepted MHDV make-ready pilot participants, including education about both software and hardware-based solutions.** This education should be prioritized and more actively provided to site designs that would trigger particularly long lead times for utility-side upgrades. This education should also align or potentially refer customers to the Load Management Technology Incentive Program (LMTIP), which can supplement MHDV pilot funding as it relates specifically to the enabling software- and hardware-based solutions.



Conclusion

VGIC appreciates the opportunity to provide these comments and looks forward to working with the Commission, the joint utilities, and other stakeholders to ensure the success of New York's transportation electrification efforts.

Respectfully submitted,

Zach Woogen

A handwritten signature in black ink, appearing to read "Zach Woogen", is positioned above the printed name.

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